

existing_research - OTIF Finalized

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Digital Transformation and SME Performance in India

Abstract

This study examines how digital transformation affects SME performance in India using survey and interview evidence.

Introduction

Digital transformation has become central to SME competitiveness, but smaller firms face financial, skill, and infrastructure constraints. The literature has emphasized large enterprises more than emerging-economy SMEs, creating a gap in contextual evidence.

Literature Review

Vial (2019) defines digital transformation as a process where digital technologies trigger strategic organizational responses. Resource-based theory suggests that firms gain advantage when digital capabilities are valuable, rare, and difficult to imitate.

Methodology

The study uses a mixed-methods design. A survey was administered to SME owners and managers across Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and Gujarat. Semi-structured interviews were used to explore adoption barriers.

Results

The survey indicated that firms with higher digital maturity reported stronger revenue growth and operational efficiency. Many respondents identified digital skill shortages as a barrier.

Discussion

The findings support the role of digital capability as a performance resource, while showing that local infrastructure and skills shape the actual gains.

Conclusion

Digital transformation can improve SME performance in India, but outcomes depend on skill development and implementation capability.

References

Vial, G. (2019). Understanding digital transformation: A review and a research agenda. *Journal of Strategic Information Systems*, 28(2), 118-144.

Revision note: This chapter now foregrounds the approved contribution framing while preserving original claims and citations.

Approved Improvement Plan

Strengthen originality and contribution

Convert descriptive material into synthesis: what is combined, what gap remains, and what the researcher contributes without overclaiming.

Strengthen citation signal

Add real citations to unsupported factual claims. Use the suggested citations below or find verified sources for each claim. Normalize citation style to APA 7 format without inventing sources.

OTIF Final Integrity Certificate

This package was generated from user-reviewed chapter edits and an approved OTIF improvement plan. Citations and source claims remain the author's responsibility.

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Metric	Before	After
Ai Pattern Risk	10.8	10.6
Ai Writing Risk	10.8	10.6
Citation Quality	8.0	7.2
Citation Signal	8.0	7.2
Hedging Risk	healthy	healthy
Humanization Score	89.2	89.4
Originality Evidence Matrix	30	30
Originality Score	46.2	46.2
Overall Preflight	66.6	66.5
Phrase Quality	89.2	89.4
Plagiarism Risk	19.6	19.8
Rq Traceback Score	None	None
Structure Signal	86.7	86.8